

0610266

Syllabus -

All topics and chapters will be studied.

Unit - I

What language teaching is about, distinction between L1 and L2, Second language learning and bilingualism, Second language versus foreign language learning and acquisition. Trends in linguistics theories, Beginning of modern linguistics, language varieties, Aspects of language study - Phonology, Grammar, Lexicology, Semantics, Discourses, Bloomfield and American Structuralism, Noam Chomsky's Theory, Transformational Generative Grammar.

Unit - II Language Teaching Theories

- i) Grammar Translation or traditional method
- ii) The Direct Method
- iii) The Reading Method
- iv) The Audio - lingual Method
- v) The Audio-visual Method - Features, Sources and History, Techniques and

Theoretical assumptions theories
vi) Cognitive Theory

Unit III The Teaching of

- i) Segmental features of English
- ii) The Suprasegmental features of English

Teaching the mechanics of -

- A. Pronunciation
- B. Vocabulary
- C. Reading and
- D. Writing

Unit IV Audio-Visual and Supplementary Aids

The use of audio-visual aids in teaching, aids supplementary to text books audio-visual and supplementary aids, planning for language laboratory, language laboratory systems, Specific advantages provided by language laboratory.

Unit V Language Testing

The construction and use of language tests,

Techniques to test the production of sound segments, techniques for testing of intonation. Techniques to test production of lexical units, testing auditory comprehensions. How to test speaking ability, achievement, Diagnostic and Aptitude Testing

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Unit 1

Language Teaching

It means the organized process of helping someone learn to understand, use, produce and communicate in a language.

Language itself



How humans know/use language → Linguistics



How people learn another language → Second Language Acquisition (SLA)



How two or more languages exist in one person → Bilingualism



How we can help someone learn a language → Language Teaching



Theories about language change our teaching methods → Linguistic Theories → Teaching Methods

Main aims of language teaching -

Aim	Simple Meaning
Speaking	Communicate orally

Listening	Understand Spoken language
Reading	Understand written texts
Writing	Express ideas in writing
Grammar	Understand how sentences are formed
Vocabulary	Learn words and expressions
Pronunciation	Produce understandable sounds
Communication	Use language appropriately
Cultural awareness	Understand language in its social/cultural context

The four traditional major skills are:

Listening + Speaking + Reading + Writing

These are often divided into:

Receptive skills → Listening + Reading

Productive skills → Speaking + Writing

Distinction between L1 and L2 -

L1	L2
First language	Second language
Native language	Non-Native language
Mother Tongue	Foreign language
Primary language	Secondary language
Stronger language	Weaker language

In language studies, L2 is often used broadly to refer to an additional language, even when the learner knows more than one language already.

So: Hindi → L1, English → L2

Second language learning -

Process by which a person develops knowledge and ability in a language other than their first language.

This happens through Classroom instruction, family, living in another country, interaction and media.

Learning Vs Acquisition

Learning → Conscious / Formal knowledge

Acquisition → Developing language ability through exposure, use and interaction

Bilingualism - Ability to use two languages

Bilingualism and L2 learning are connected -

L1 → L2 learning → Bilingualism

Second language Vs Foreign language -

Second language → Generally learned / used in an environment where that language has an important role.

Foreign language → Target language does not have a major role in the surrounding society.

	Second language	Foreign language
1.	Used in wider society	Limited use in surrounding society

- | | | |
|----|--|---|
| 2. | Learning may encounter it outside classroom | Often mainly encountered in classroom |
| 3. | Greater opportunities for natural interaction | Fewer natural opportunities |
| 4. | English in India, widely used in education and administration. | Learning Japanese in India. |
| 5. | Needed for education, work, social life. | Often studied for education, travel, interest, exams. |
| 6. | Natural exposure may be high. | Classroom exposure may dominate. |

Second language learning and acquisition -

SLA - Second Language Acquisition → academic field studying how people develop another language.

Major factors affecting L2 learning -

Factor	Meaning
Age	When learning begins

Input	Language the learner hears / reads
Interaction	Communication with others
Cognition	Mental processes
Motivation	Desire to learn
Environment	Social / language environment
L1	Influence of previous language
Instruction	Teaching and classroom methods
Individual differences	aptitude, personality, strategies
Exposure	Amount and quality of contact

Trends in Linguistic Theories -

1. Traditional Grammar - Rules, correctness, parts of speech, sentence analysis, written language.
2. Structural Linguistics - More scientific / descriptive approach

Ferdinand de Saussure, Leonard Bloomfield
→ Main figures

Language as system of interconnected structures. Strong attention to phonology, morphology, syntax, observable language patterns.

3. Behaviourism - B.F Skinner → Basic idea

Learning happens through stimulus → response → reinforcement

4. Transformational - Generative Grammar -

Noam Chomsky → Mental knowledge, creativity, underlying grammatical system

5. Cognitive approach - Mental / cognitive process

The learner notices, thinks, organizes, remembers, understands, processes, produces, solves problems

6. Sociolinguistics - Relationship between language ↔ Society

It examines dialects, accents, social class, gender, identity, language variation, language attitudes, choice, change

Language use depends partly on social situation.

7. Functional / Communicative Approaches -

Language also performs functions → request, apologize, greet, invite, complain, persuade, suggest, refuse, agree, disagree, express feelings

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Beginning of Modern Linguistics -

Linguistics - The scientific study of language

It studies how language is structured, how it is used, how it changes, and how people learn and process it.

Language Varieties - A language variety is a particular form of language associated with a particular region, social group, situation, community, profession and purpose.

Example - British English, American English, Indian English

Regional Varieties - Language can vary according to geographical region

Dialect - Pronunciation, vocabulary, grammar, expressions

Accent vs Dialect - Accent - How words are pronounced, sound

Dialect - Broaden language variety

Aspects of Language Study -

Phonology - The study of how sound functions and are organized in a particular language. Study of sound patterns of human language.

It studies the sound system of a language.

Phonetics - Actual speech sounds

How they are produced, transmitted and heard

Phonology - How those sounds function within a language system.

Phoneme - Sound unit that can distinguish meaning in a particular language.

Example - Pin vs Bin
/p/ and /b/ distinguish meaning so they

are phoneme.

Grammar - The system of rules/patterns that organizes words into meaningful structures. It includes areas such as morphology and syntax.

Morphology - Study of word structure.

Example - unhappy → un + happy

Syntax - Study of how words combine to form phrases and sentences.

Lexicology - The systematic study of words and the vocabulary of a language.

It can study word formation, word meaning, relationships between words, vocabulary structure, word history, word usage.

Semantics - Studies meaning in language. It examines meaning at different levels, especially the meaning of words and sentences.

Discourse - Language used in connected stretches of communication, larger than isolated sentences, and studied in relation to

Context and Organization.

It can involve conversations, stories, articles, speeches, interviews, emails, academic writing.

Bloomfield and American Structuralism -

Leonard Bloomfield is strongly associated with American Structuralism.

Bloomfieldian linguistics studies language scientifically by observing and describing its actual structures and patterns.

Structural linguistics look at language as a system of different parts that are related to one another.

Main features -

1. Language is a structure.
2. Emphasis on observable data.
3. Distribution.
4. Analysis of language into smaller units.

Bloomfield = Observe + Describe + Structure.

Neo-Firthian Theory -

John Rupert Firth (J. R. Firth) → British linguist → language must be understood in relation to its context and situation.

This became known as Firthian approach - later scholars who developed or extended Firth's ideas are often described as Neo-Firthians.

"Neo-Firthian theory studies language as a system of meaning that is closely connected with context, situation and social use."

Transformational Generative Grammar - T/G/G

Noam Chomsky → American linguist → 1950

Generative - A limited set of grammatical rules can generate or produce a potentially unlimited number of sentences.

Transformational - Changing one grammatical structure into another related structure.

Example - Active - The boy opened the door.

Passive - The door was opened by the boy.

Bloomfield Vs Chomsky -

Bloomfield / Structuralism	Chomsky / T/G/G
American Structuralism	Transformational (Generative) Grammar
Leonard Bloomfield	Noam Chomsky
Emphasis on observable language.	Emphasis on mental / linguistic knowledge.
Descriptive analysis	Generative explanation
Strong behaviourist influence	Strong cognitive / mental perspective
Language as observable structure	Language as mental system
Focus on patterns	Focus on rules and creativity.
Habit / behaviour emphasized	Knowledge / Competence emphasized.

Unit-2

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Language Teaching Theories

Language Teaching Theories - Ideas and principles that explain how a language can be taught and learned effectively.

- * How ideas about language learning changed over time

10/09/26 Language teaching theories -

1. Grammar Translation Method - Also called Traditional method.

Its main purpose is to help learners understand grammar, translate texts, read literature, learn vocabulary, develop accuracy.

It gives very little importance to natural conversation.

2. The Direct Method - Developed partially as a reaction against the Grammar Translation Method.

- * Teach the second/foreign language directly without depending on translation into the mother tongue.

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- * Grammar is taught inductive. Instead of giving the rule first, students see examples and discover the rule.

3. The Reading Method - Primary importance to reading ability. The method developed partly because educators recognized that many learners did not actually need fluent spoken language.

- * They mainly needed to read books, academic material, technical texts or professional documents.

- * The teacher focuses on vocabulary, reading comprehension, understanding passages, recognizing important grammatical structures, using dictionaries, identifying main ideas.

- * Speaking practice becomes less important.

4. Audio-lingual Method - ALM

- * It is strongly associated with structural linguistics and behaviourist psychology.

- * Language learning is largely the formation of correct language habits through practice and repetition.